

YACHATDAC

Truth — Legacy, Research & Discovery

Timeline runs present to past. No filters, no sorting. Suzanne's section is a full-bleed dark break that cannot be skipped.

HERO

Most people have never heard of the Iningai.

This is what happened here, told by the people it happened to.

Start from the beginning ↓ Research & partnerships ↓

[Two buttons. The first scrolls to the oldest section at the foot; the second to the research card mid-page.]

THE TIMELINE

AHEAD — WHAT IS BEING BUILT

WITHIN FIVE YEARS

The Cultural Knowledge Precinct

Exhibitions, teaching, research accommodation and a place for community to gather, in one place at Turraburra. Master planning is underway.

| It is being built because there is something here worth building it for.

WRITTEN RECORD

Talk to us about being part of it → #partner

TODAY — THE WORK GOING ON

NOW

Right-way fire, springs, and two flux towers

The Iningai Rangers burn, fence, collect seed and bring springs back. Two towers measure what that does to the carbon in the soil — one on Country managed this way, one on grazed land, checked against each other.

| They can do this work because, seven years ago, this stopped being someone else's station.

LIVING MEMORY

What the towers are showing → /resources/right-way-fire-and-the-carbon-in-the-soil

2022

The site is studied with its owners

A two-year study documents Marra Wonga from both archaeological and Iningai perspectives, with Iningai community members as research partners rather than subjects.

| Iningai people could be partners in that research because, by then, there were Iningai people the researchers had to ask.

SCIENCE

Read the findings → </resources/fifteen-thousand-markings-read-in-order>

2026 BACK TO 2003 — BOUGHT BACK

12:15PM, FRIDAY 26 JUNE 2026

The deed of grant

Turraburra is signed over outright. No longer held on our behalf, no longer shackled to anyone else's conditions.

| Owning it outright is not the same as getting it back. Getting it back took seven years longer, and nearly did not happen at all.

WRITTEN RECORD

Suzanne's account of how it happened → </resources/it-nearly-didnt-happen>

1 OCTOBER 2020

Gracevale becomes Turraburra

The station is renamed and officially launched as Turraburra, after the Terraburra clan recorded on this Country in an 1884 map.

| The name went back before the deed did.

WRITTEN RECORD

2:30PM, 30 APRIL 2019

And then it was just us

The Indigenous Land and Sea Corporation had purchased the property and leased it to YACHATDAC eleven days earlier. Now the owner drove off it. There was no furniture in the house, so everyone slept on the floor. That first night Mark told them to be quiet and listen.

| It had to be bought incognito. Once anyone knew who the money was really for, the price would have gone up.

LIVING MEMORY

Read what it took → </resources/it-nearly-didnt-happen>

2003

Suzanne's father

He spent his life fencing and protecting the sites out here, and holding two families together with photographs and envelopes and names. When she came back after he died, nothing had been done since.

| He was carrying on his own father's work, and his grandfather's. The relationships that kept this Country reachable were held by people who never owned an acre of it.

LIVING MEMORY

My father's dream → </resources/it-nearly-didnt-happen>

1950S — ADMIRER UNDER THE WRONG NAME

1950S

They called it The Art Gallery

By the 1950s the escarpment has a name given to it by visitors, and it is not an Iningai one. The site is written up, photographed and admired under that name for decades.

— Nobody corrected them, because by then there was almost nobody left to do it.

WRITTEN RECORD

Who named it, and what it was called before → </resources/when-they-called-it-the-art-gallery>

[Inline card after the precinct entry — WORK WITH US / Partnerships / A researcher on Country is a guest on Country. Partnerships here are expected to give something back to the land and the people. → </connect>]

[Inline card after the 2022 entry — MORE OF THIS / Research & discovery → </resources/#research-and-discovery>]

THE SEAM

[Full-bleed dark section. The timeline stops: no rail, no markers, no tags, no way past it. In print it takes its own page.]

[DRAFT — Suzanne's words, from the Unfinished Business and Yacadak Framework recordings, lightly edited for reading. Not published until she has seen and approved it.]

1902, AND THEN FURTHER BACK

By 1902 there were thirty-seven.

[Circular photo of Suzanne. Told by / Suzanne Thompson / Iningai custodian · Founder and Managing Director, YACHATDAC]

And I'm a descendant of one of those 37.

To understand that number you have to go back sixteen years, to a drought, and to a decision made out of concern.

1902 · 37 Iningai adults recorded in the area, and three children.

1886 · 7,500 Blankets calculated as necessary for the Iningai nation, sixteen years earlier. When they arrived, some still had to be cut in half, because there were not enough to go round.

Population figures recorded in Hoch (1986), cited in Taçon et al., Australian Archaeology, 2022.

In 1886 the settlers had all come, and they'd established about 150 property landholdings. It was a great drought, and they were really concerned about the poor condition of the natives. Winter was coming. They were worried, because our people were off their lands and couldn't hunt, and had no access to their country or their foods.

So they decided we needed blankets.

What was written in the history books afterwards is that we did not exist, that we had no rights, that we had been wiped out. Up until seven years ago, by the government's account, Iningai people did not exist at all.

Well — we're still here.

Our ancestors were dispossessed and massacred in a way that meant we never got to complete the proper cultural ceremony for that grieving. Another belief arrived and said it is done this way now. That is unfinished business. There are massacre sites out here. We know where they are.

My great-great-great grandmother Polly. My great-great-great grandfather Billy. That is how I know where to hunt, and which springs to visit, and why my family is still on this Country.

[FOR SUZANNE — re-ordered so the count comes before the blankets. Two things to confirm: whether that reversal is right, and the number. Your recording says thirty-five; the published figure is thirty-seven adults and three children. Change it back if yours is the one that stands.]

THE TIMELINE RESUMES

1840S — BEFORE THE RUNS WERE TAKEN UP

What Mitchell recorded

The explorer Thomas Mitchell passes through and describes the Iningai — including huts built solidly enough to carry bark tiles on the roof.

The first written account of the people here was written by someone who had just arrived. Everyone who could have written it earlier had no reason to.

Read the passage, and what it proves → /resources/what-mitchell-wrote-down

OLDER THAN THE RECORD — CUT INTO THE WALL

The engraving starts

Over 15,000 petroglyphs and 111 stencils accumulate along 160 metres of shelter wall — animal tracks, lines, grooves, drilled holes, and human feet with six toes. The Iningai name for the place is Marra Wonga. It means place of many stories.

Ten clusters of designs run south to north. They were made at different times. Read in that order, they tell the Seven Sisters — the sisters pursued, the boomerangs thrown, the Rainbow Serpent, the dingo watching over the one who stayed on Earth.

No other rock art site is known anywhere in the world where a story runs across the whole site. Researchers have looked.

The sisters are the Pleiades. Their story is told in more than eighty places across this continent, and in cultures on the other side of the world.

Some of it is common knowledge. Some is women's and some is men's. What is written here is the part that is told away from Country.

The site has never been scientifically dated. The pecked designs are likely more than 5,000 years old on regional style sequences; mud wasp nests over some engravings could give minimum ages if they are ever sampled.

What the study found, and how → /resources/fifteen-thousand-markings-read-in-order

Published as Marra Wonga: Archaeological and contemporary First Nations interpretations of one of central Queensland's largest rock art sites, Australian Archaeology, 2022. tandfonline.com/doi/full/10.1080/03122417.2022.2084666

[Inline card — STILL TO BE FOUND / Open research / Most of this Country has never been studied. Researchers wanted in palaeontology and archaeology, ecology and biodiversity, and medicinal botany. → /partnerships/#research-opportunities]

CLOSING SECTION — FULL WIDTH, ESCARPMENT PHOTOGRAPH BEHIND

BEFORE PEOPLE · ABOUT 100 MILLION YEARS AGO

All of this was under water

The Eromanga Sea covers most of inland Queensland. Sediment settles on its floor, hardens, and becomes the sandstone of the escarpment. The wall they marked was already the oldest thing here.

Creatures stand in the mud at the edge of it, where the mangroves would have been, and the prints set. They are still here. So are petrified trees, and what one visiting specialist thinks may be dinosaur eggs. The soil profiles match Winton, where the dinosaurs were found.

Almost none of it has been studied.

How the seabed became the escarpment → /resources/you-are-standing-on-a-seabed